

THEMIS

The AI companion for in-house counsel

Themis prepares the matter — the facts, the options, the assumptions and what the request left out — so the lawyer can reach the decision and be present in the room.

Brian Harris · Founder
Pre-seed · September 2026



The business needs an answer. The lawyer has to find the question first.

THE REQUEST

“Can we reuse two years of customer transaction data for card and lending offers?”

It does not say which customers, under which consent, or that the data-aggregator contract renews in three weeks.

THE WORK BEFORE THE ADVICE

- 1 **Reconstruct** the facts that change the analysis.
- 2 **Research** an issue outside the lawyer’s depth.
- 3 **Work out** the options and what separates them.
- 4 **Translate** it into advice the business can act on.

20%

of a general counsel’s time goes to drafting. The rest is meetings, business context, and the risks they are expected to see coming before anyone asks.

Themis prepares the matter. The lawyer explores the answer space.

01

Prepare

A half-formed request becomes a matter: the purpose, the facts, the participants, the deadline — and an explicit list of what the request left out.

02

Explore

Research and drafts arrive with the material assumptions visible, the options set side by side, and the questions that would change the answer.

03

Decide

The lawyer records the decision. Themis keeps the reasoning, the alternatives considered, and the basis, attached to the matter.

- *The lawyer directs the inquiry and owns the decision. Themis does the preparation.*

A half-formed request in. A prepared matter out.

MATTER • RELAY: OPEN-BANKING REAUTHENTICATION AND DATA USE • WAITING ON YOUR JUDGMENT

REQUIRED WORK

Select the customer reauthentication path

Stage: Waiting on your judgment. Brian Harris must act next: Select the customer reauthentication path

Matter at a glance

Relay is moving about 280,000 customers from credential-based bank connections to OAuth and bank APIs. Product prefers to let existing connections continue until a bank requires reauthentication, while Growth wants to use two years of transaction history for card and lending offers. The current consent does not clearly disclose these uses or set a deletion period after disconnection. Legal guidance is needed before the aggregator contract renews on September 15.

Question to resolve

Should Relay let existing bank connections continue until each customer must reauthenticate, or require all 280,000 customers to reauthorize within 90 days? In either case, should marketing and lending uses require separate consent, and should disconnected-account data be deleted after 30 days?

WHAT IT SEPARATED

One request, two different uses: keeping existing bank connections alive, and mining two years of transaction history for card and lending offers.

WHAT IT SURFACED

The question the business never asked — when must 280,000 customers reauthorize, and does marketing use need its own consent?

WHAT IT LEFT TO THE LAWYER

The decision, and the reason for it, recorded on the matter.

The lawyer never had to brief the matter. It was prepared before they opened it.

Everyone else ships the answer. Themis prepares the matter.

THE DIFFERENCE

■ General assistants

Claude and ChatGPT are powerful and already on the lawyer's desk. The lawyer still has to design the system and rebuild the context every time.

■ Legal platforms

Harvey, Legora, CoCounsel and GC AI produce strong work product — built for firms and departments with the staff to run them.

■ Themis

The matter is already prepared when the lawyer opens it. One lawyer. No configuration.

WHY IT COMPOUNDS

Every matter leaves a record.

The facts, the assumptions, the options considered, the decision — and the reason for it.

The record is the lawyer's own precedent library.

It is not in the model, it is not in the vendor, and it does not transfer when they switch.

Recommendation and recorded decision stay separate.

That is an architecture choice, not a feature, and it is not something a general answer engine retrofits.

Built by the buyer.

Brian Harris

Sole founder

17 years

practicing law, including two founding general counsel roles and product counsel at scale.

■ SETTLE • MANIFEST

Founding General Counsel and Chief Compliance Officer, then founding Chief Legal Officer. Built both legal and compliance functions from zero.

■ AFFIRM

Product and regulatory counsel leadership through a fintech scale-up. Grew the team from three attorneys to eight.

■ FACEBOOK PORTAL

Associate General Counsel. Advised product teams through launches and regulatory review.

■ GEORGIA TECH • NORTHWESTERN

AI research in document classification and automated redaction. M.S. Computer Science. J.D.

The first legal hire has no one to ask. I have done that job twice.

A founding engineer is the first hire this round funds.

Legal teams are deciding how AI fits — with the headcount they already have.

36%

of surveyed legal departments are actively deploying generative AI.

63%

of surveyed chief legal officers expect their headcount to stay flat.

Budget is moving to tools, not to hiring. The seat goes to whatever makes the lawyer already in the room measurably more capable.

The first legal hire is the first buyer.

WHO

- Solo general counsel and first product counsel at U.S. technology and fintech companies.
- Frequent launches, no research support, and no one else in the building to ask.
- Already paying for Claude or ChatGPT on a departmental card.

WHY THEY TRY

- A live matter that is larger than the bandwidth they have for it.
- They can start on one seat, this month, without a procurement cycle or an annual commitment.
- The first matter is the demo.

HOW THEY ARRIVE

- The founder's counsel network opens the first pilots.
- Useful work on a real matter earns the next matter.
- Paid use earns a referral or a second seat on the same team.

FIRST 90 DAYS AFTER PILOT ACCESS

20 qualified conversations

10 pilot lawyers

5 paying lawyers

\$400 a month. One seat. No contract.

\$400

per lawyer, per month

- Monthly billing
- Start with a single seat
- No setup fee
- No annual commitment

24 min

a week

At an assumed \$250 per lawyer hour, twenty-four minutes a week of recovered capacity covers the price of the seat.

That is the bar the product has to clear, and it is deliberately a low one.

WHAT WE HAVE NOT MEASURED

We have no production usage, so we have no cost basis. Model, research and hosting cost per matter is unknown.

We are not claiming a gross margin. Establishing real unit economics is a deliverable of this raise, not an assumption inside it.

One seat is the entry point, not the ceiling. Expansion is a second seat on the same team, then the department.

Start with one lawyer. The seat market is \$696M before anyone buys a second.

01

Beachhead

Solo general counsel and small product legal teams at U.S. technology and fintech companies.

We are not claiming a count for this segment. Sizing it credibly is part of what this raise buys.

02

The seat market

\$696M

145,000 U.S. in-house lawyers × \$4,800 a year, in annual subscription revenue.

Full adoption at a constant price. Not a forecast.

03

Expansion

A second seat on the same team, then the department.

The budget Themis ultimately competes for is outside counsel spend, which dwarfs the seat market.

\$696M models full adoption at a constant price. It is not a forecast and no obtainable share is claimed. Population: ACC 2025 analysis of 2024 BLS employment data. Pricing is proposed.

The prototype works. Two lawyers have asked to pilot it.

■ BUILT

A working prototype: intake, matters, research, editable work product and recorded decisions.

Four in-house counsel discovery interviews, August 2026.

■ SIGNAL

A deputy general counsel at a consumer fintech agreed to serve as design partner and pilot user.

A head of legal at a data company committed to pilot on release and is scoping AI budget.

A third general counsel offered an introduction into the legal-AI operator network.

■ NOT YET PROVEN

No paying customer and no production usage.

No measured time saving and no delivery cost basis.

No evidence yet that a lawyer returns with a second matter.

18-MONTH TARGETS

50 paying lawyers

\$240K ARR

60% start a second matter within 30 days

25% less total preparation effort

\$1.5M to put a prepared matter in front of every small-team lawyer.

\$1.5M

Pre-seed · 18 months of focused execution

WHAT IT BUYS

- A founding technical team
- Live use on real matters with working lawyers
- A real cost basis and honest unit economics
- Evidence that lawyers return and pay

THE TEST THIS MONEY FUNDS

- 1 **Lawyers use it** on live matters, unprompted.
- 2 **They return** with a second matter, and they pay.
- 3 **Total preparation effort falls** against the tools they already use.
- 4 **Delivery cost** supports the price.

Pass that test and the next round is raised on retention evidence, not on a thesis.

Themis equips lawyers to advise with confidence — and gives them more time to be present in the room, shaping business decisions.

The alternatives already do useful legal work.

Alternative	What it already does well	What Themis has to earn
Claude / ChatGPT	Research, drafting, custom instructions and workflows. Claude ships a legal plugin configured to organizational playbooks.	Less effort spent directing the matter, with the useful questions surfaced rather than prompted for.
Harvey / Legora	Legal agents, research, document review, and work adapted to a customer’s own methods and preferences.	A daily experience that fits a team of one, at a price and a commitment a single lawyer can approve.
CoCounsel / GC AI	Legal work product and research. GC AI sells directly to in-house counsel, including individual seats.	Better preparation on the buyer’s own live matters, not general capability on legal tasks.

Positioning comparison, not a controlled benchmark. Feature overlap is substantial, and several of these platforms already market judgment support.

Sources checked September 2026: claude.com/plugins/legal • openai.com/projects • harvey.ai/platform/agents • legora.com • legal.thomsonreuters.com/cocounsel • gc.ai/pricing

A seat model with a low entry commitment.

Scope or benchmark	Basis	Annual amount
Full U.S. in-house model	145,000 seats × \$4,800	\$696M
Scale illustration	21,000 seats × \$4,800 (14.5% of the U.S. estimate)	\$100.8M
One Themis seat, proposed	12 monthly payments of \$400	\$4,800
GC AI, published individual price	1 seat × \$500 × 12 months	\$6,000
Harvey, buyer-reported quote	5 seats × \$425 × 12-month term	\$25,500

Small technology and fintech legal teams first. Broader in-house use follows demonstrated value, not the other way round.

An 18-month plan to establish paid use.

Use of funds	Proposed budget
Founder and technical delivery	\$900,000
Customer development	\$180,000
Models, research and infrastructure	\$150,000
Secure pilot delivery and operations	\$120,000
Contingency	\$150,000
Total	\$1,500,000

THE FUNDING TEST

- Lawyers use it on live matters.
- They return with a second matter, and they pay.
- Total preparation effort falls.
- Delivery cost supports the price.

At \$400 a month, fifty paid seats produce about \$20,000 in monthly recurring revenue against an average spend envelope near \$83,000 a month. This round funds validation and company building, not a path to break-even.

Proposed budget, not approved spend or a committed raise. Hiring sequence, founder compensation and financing terms remain open.